

Judgment Under Uncertainty: Heuristics and Biases

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Publication context: 1982

Corpus priority: Phase 1

Document type: Synthesized RAG source dossier built from publicly available online material

Purpose In This RAG Corpus

- This is the scholarly backbone behind modern bias theory and many later popular works.
- It adds research credibility and more formal grounding for RAG outputs intended for serious audiences.
- It broadens the corpus beyond a single trade-book narrative into an edited academic volume.

Key Concepts And Retrieval Tags

- representativeness_bias
- availability_heuristic
- anchoring_bias
- overconfidence_bias
- risk_perception
- corrective_procedures

Core Learnings

- People use heuristics because they are cognitively efficient, but these shortcuts can systematically mislead judgment under uncertainty.
- Representativeness can drive judgments that ignore base rates, sample size, and statistical structure.
- Availability can distort estimates of frequency, plausibility, and risk salience.
- Anchoring and adjustment errors are especially relevant when people produce numerical estimates, thresholds, or forecasts.
- The collection is valuable because it links these patterns to laboratory evidence, social judgment, medical decision-making, and corrective methods.

Directions, Observations, And Implications

- Use the volume for academically grounded explanations when you need more than management-friendly summaries.
- Retrieve this source for scenarios involving probability judgment, risk estimation, diagnosis, and forecasting.
- Pair its heuristics with practical mitigation steps from later books such as Noise, Nudge, and Superforecasting.

How This Can Be Applied In Decision Making

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How This Strengthens A Bias-Aware RAG System

- Provides rigorous grounding for heuristic-driven error and for explaining why intuitive predictions can be systematically wrong.
- Helps the RAG system distinguish between descriptive psychology and intervention design.
- Useful for future citation-oriented outputs and evidence-based source ranking.

Limitations And Cautions

- This dossier is synthesized from accessible abstracts, tables of contents, and chapter summaries rather than the full edited volume.
- The full book contains many contributors and domains, so future ingestion of licensed text would deepen retrieval coverage.

Source Notes

- PubMed abstract for the foundational article (abstract): <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/17835457/>
- Cambridge University Press chapter summary (chapter_summary): <https://www.cambridge.org/core/books/judgment-under-uncertainty/judgment-under-uncertainty-heuristics-and-biases/9086E911E7585FE81DE70A4FA96AEA13>
- Open Library overview of the edited volume (library_summary): https://openlibrary.org/works/OL12970183W/Judgement_under_uncertainty

RAG Ingestion Note

This document is intentionally written as a concise, retrieval-friendly synthesis rather than as a book review. It is designed to help the system retrieve named biases and decision failures, practical mitigation methods, organizational and AI-governance implications, and scenario-to-concept mappings for user prompts.